

Building a Nail Care Routine

Prescribing for a real person — across nail type, climate, maintenance capacity, and budget

Learning Objectives

- Recommend an at-home routine appropriate to a client's nail type and lifestyle
- Adjust nail care recommendations for India's monsoon and dry-season conditions
- Set a realistic maintenance schedule for gel and extension clients
- Prescribe within a client's budget without compromising nail health

A routine, not just a rebooking reminder

What a client does with her hands between appointments matters as much as anything done in your chair. A genuinely useful routine recommendation is specific to her nails, her climate, and her real life — not a generic three-step card handed to every client regardless of what she actually needs.

The four-piece at-home foundation

1. **Cuticle oil** — applied daily, the single highest-impact home habit for nail and cuticle health.
2. **Hand cream with SPF** — protects against the same UV damage and visible ageing taught in Course I, applied to hands as consistently as to the face.
3. **A gentle, non-acetone remover** for any at-home colour changes between salon visits, reducing the drying, dehydrating effect of repeated acetone exposure.
4. **Gloves for wet or chemical household work** — protecting both polish and the natural nail plate from repeated water and detergent exposure, a leading cause of splitting and peeling nails.

India's climate: what changes and why

- **Monsoon and humid conditions.** Increased moisture exposure raises fungal infection risk, per Module Three — recommend clients dry hands and feet thoroughly after any wet exposure, and consider a slightly longer gap between pedicures if closed, damp footwear is worn daily during the season.
- **Dry winter conditions.** Favour richer cuticle oil and hand cream, applied more frequently, as low humidity accelerates the brittleness and splitting discussed in Module Eight.

A realistic maintenance schedule

Set expectations honestly at the point of service, not as a surprise at the next appointment: gel typically needs attention every two to three weeks before natural regrowth causes visible lifting, and extensions need infill or removal on a similar schedule to avoid the lever-effect damage covered in Module Six. A client who understands this upfront is far more likely to return on schedule than one left to guess.

Prescribing within a budget

If a client's budget is limited, prioritise cuticle oil first — the single cheapest, highest-impact daily habit — and a well-fitted pair of household gloves second. A simple, well-maintained natural manicure with regular cuticle care will consistently outperform an expensive but neglected extension system for long-term nail health.

Key Terms

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[object Object]

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Practical Activity · The Full Prescription

Using the assessment card from Module Three and the baseline record from Module Two, build a complete four-piece at-home routine for that same client or model,

including one seasonal adjustment and a realistic maintenance schedule. **File this alongside your earlier records for the capstone.**